

Getting the tubing right

In the previous chapter, we explained everything you'll need to do when you're cutting and bending your tubing whether it's soft or hard. You need to connect the tubing one by one unless you're already experienced. Start off from the pump towards the CPU water block. From the water block, you should connect the tube to the radiator. If you happen to cool your GPU too, then you should connect the pump to the GPU block and the GPU to the CPU block followed by the radiator. This will be the case if you're using one pump. You can also use a T-splitter from the pump to go to the CPU and GPU block individually. However, you will need two radiators for each as well.

Soft tubing is the easiest and won't take much time. Since we are using compression fittings, we will have the lock rings already removed from the fittings. Insert two lock rings at the two ends of the tubing and then push the tube over the fitting. Tighten up the lock ring with your fingers for a secure fit. Don't apply too much force while tightening the fittings and don't even use wrenches for soft tubes.



Avoid using wrenches while tightening tube fittings

When you're dealing with hard tubing, it's going to be a trial and error process until you get the right bends. You already know how the bending and cutting is carried out from the last chapter. The silicon insert is super important and don't forget to dip it in soapy water so that it doesn't get stuck inside. Keep fitting the tubes in the loop and checking whether you're getting the expected design. Once you're satisfied with them, leave the tubes to cool off. Give them a wash since there might be chippings remaining when it was cut. Again, don't apply too much pressure while tightening the compression or push-in fittings. If you've used acrylic tubes, they might even crack and lead to leakages. Make sure the ends of the tubes are smooth. You can use a reamer or sandpaper as well. Give them a final check and now you're ready to start pouring the fluid.